of the principal men in the villages to me to request me to endeavour to get them placed under my charge; also this for certain reasons I did not then do. But I think of trying to get it for next year, and if I succeed it will bring me in a most hansome revenue, I should think to begin with, not less than £1000. one thousand pounds. The deputies from the villages offered to give me their bond for five hundred, if I could get the matter arranged. This money accrues from 10 pr cent on the Govt taxes which is paid by the villagers to their chief to remunerate him for his trouble in protecting them, and other fees, fines etc. which he gets from them. And this amount might be doubled or perhaps trebled by good government and kind treatment. The American missionaries have urged me strongly to undertake this matter; and they say that by doing so I shall deserve the blessings of all Christendom for protecting a number of suffering Christians from the oppression and tyranny of their Mahomedan chiefs. It will be a most difficult business to manage as these villages are now in the hands of the nobles of Afshar (Nadir Shah's tribe) who are perhaps the most turbulent, proud and unruly of all the nobles of Persia. These men would, to a man, oppose me and with reason for from a village which in the Govt books is rated at say Ts. 300. pr annm, they take six. Half they account to the Govt for and half is their own profit.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO MRS. HENRY BURGESS] *Tabreez, June 6, 1844*

On the 13th ulto I received yours of the 23 March. I am very sorry to hear of the death of Mr. and Mrs. Webbe. You my dear Mother must have felt the death of the latter acutely. She was almost the only person I recollect with whom you were on terms of intimacy and friendship. In mentioning your having heard Mozarts requiem you write "do not think I am grown superstitious." If you knew *how* superstitious your son was, you would not think it necessary to write that sentence. It is rather curious that your letter should have arrived a few days after I had written mine (9th May) about the jins.— I have just received a long letter from uncle and aunt E. Smith, the latter's letter is full of "Said" and unfortunately in answering it I quite forgot to mention any thing about him, which is an omission I am sorry for. I would have congratulated them upon their adopted son, when one can please people by paying them a few empty compliments I usually make it a rule to do so, particularly people who have been so kind to me as they have. Can you tell me what breed Mr Said is of. In Egypt Arabia and Persia there are three kinds of slaves well known to commerce; the first is the Abyssinian which are worth from all prices 25 to 500 £ or even more, the next the Nubian who are not so good, and the last the thorough bred negro who are dear at 6 or 7 £, their average price here. I am afraid they have been cheated so please tell me what breed Mr Said is.

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